Answers and talk notes

Unit 1 Practice

What your student is learning

Tonight is practice for the Unit 1 test. Almost every question is dividing with fractions, and the biggest one asks your student to explain a picture — not just write an answer.

Answers

Ask your student to explain before you look.

1. **A.** 4/3. The reciprocal flips the numerator and denominator, so the reciprocal of 3/4 is 4/3.
2. **C.** 3/2. 1 × 2 + 1 = 3, so 1 1/2 = 3/2.
3. **B.** 4. Four fourths make 1 whole, so there are 4 fourths in 1.
4. **D.** 10. There are 2 halves in each whole, so 5 ÷ 1/2 = 5 × 2 = 10.
5. **A.** 12. Multiply by the reciprocal: 8 × 3/2 = 24/2 = 12.

Talk about it

How many pieces of size 1/3 fit in 2 wholes, and why is the number bigger than 2?

Home mission

Cut two paper strips. Make one a whole length and the other half as long. Call them 1 1/2 yards of ribbon. Fold the long strip into 4 equal parts and the short strip into 2 equal parts. Count the parts. How many bows? Write the division sentence together.

When they are stuck, ask

- Can you draw the amount and cut it into the small pieces? How many sections do you get?
- Is there a mixed number here? What do we always do to it first?
- You have a number — now what does it mean in the story? Whole ones, or whole ones and part of another?

Try not to say

- Flip the first fraction instead of the second.
- Leave the answer as 28/6 — an improper fraction is close enough.
- The leftover half means half a cup.